

Airways

We never really think about breathing because it is such an automatic process, but it is vital to our survival. Every inward breath brings a new supply of air into the network of tubes that make up the respiratory system. These take air deep into the lungs, where the gas oxygen, which is vital for life, passes into the blood to be carried all around the body.

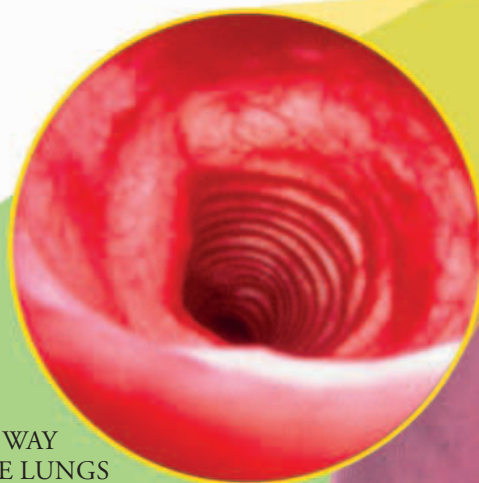
THE RESPIRATORY SYSTEM

Your lungs and the airways that carry air in and out of your body are located in your head and chest. The airways include the nasal cavity, the throat, the larynx (voice box), and the branching passages inside your lungs. Incoming air is cleaned as it travels through your nose and trachea to remove dirt and germs that could block or damage the delicate lungs.

Air is warmed and cleaned as it passes through the nasal cavity.

The epiglottis is a flap at the front of the voice box.

The voice box, or larynx, produces sounds.



► THIS WAY TO THE LUNGS

The ridged appearance of the trachea is produced by rings of rubbery cartilage that hold it open during breathing and stop it from closing up.



Oxygen

OXYGEN SUPPLY

We breathe in oxygen and breathe out waste carbon dioxide. So why doesn't our oxygen supply run out? Plants ensure there is a steady supply in the air by releasing oxygen during photosynthesis, the process that uses sunlight and carbon dioxide to make food.

Carbon dioxide

